CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

# PET GROOMING SALON OWNER IN THE AI ERA

You can't automate a nervous doodle in a tub. Grooming stays hands-on, wet and booked out.

★ **TL;DR — Owners around ~$75K on the site's scale, on a 6–12 month path to groom competently and open. The catch: skilled groomers are scarce — until you can groom, you can't judge anyone's work or cover a single shift.** ★

## THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

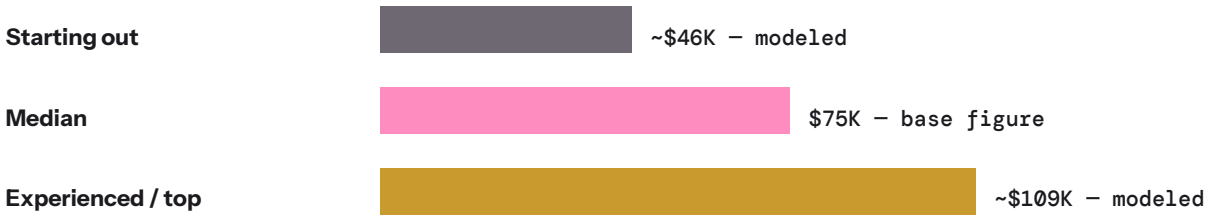
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- Demand outruns groomer supply in most suburbs; good salons book weeks out.
- Training is real: breed cuts, skin care and safe handling take months to learn properly.
- Software books and reminds; the groom itself is wet, physical and unscriptable.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

## THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS




The Career Glitch base figure for Pet Grooming Salon Owner is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

## WHAT DOES A PET GROOMING SALON OWNER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Bathe, dry, clip and style dogs to breed and pet standards

✓ Handle nervous, matted and senior pets safely
✓ Run the book: appointments, retail, rebooking
✓ Hire and train bathers and groomers

Think: a hair salon where the clients bite when scared and shake when wet.

## WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

| THE ROBOT | THE HUMAN |
|---|---|
| Booking, reminders, payments and marketing run on salon software. Photo records and notes standardize each client's preferences. | Reading a dog's stress, adapting your handling, and the scissor work itself — the entire product is calm human hands. |

⚠ **Bite risk, physical strain and matted doodle emergencies are daily; pricing them wrong burns out groomers fast.**

## THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

| THE JOB IS | THE JOB IS NOT |
|---|---|
| ✓ Booked-out weeks and loyal repeat clients<br>✓ Dogs all day — for the right person, that's the point<br>✓ Add-on services stack margin onto every ticket | ✗ Wet, hairy and loud from open to close<br>✗ Your best groomer is always one offer from leaving<br>✗ Holiday rushes are physical marathons |

Good fit? Dog-fluent, patient, steady-handed, and calm under barking chaos.
Bad fit? You're squeamish, allergic, or underestimate animals' strength.

## THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

| DOOR A — BATHER → GROOMER → OWNER | DOOR B — BUY OR BUILD AS THE OPERATOR |
|---|---|
| Start as a bather in a salon, move into grooming training (in-house or a grooming school), and build speed and a client following. Ownership then hires from a position of real skill. | The business-first route: lease a space, hire experienced groomers, and run operations while completing your own training. It works only if you can recruit — groomers are the scarce asset. |

Smart move: Offer subscription bath plans for doodles and double coats — recurring small tickets smooth the week and keep coats, and clients, manageable.
Where you land after: A full-book salon → a second location, or a premium appointment-only boutique.

## YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| START AS | TRAIN AS | WORK THE | PLAN THE | OPEN OR | FILL AND |

### STEP 1 — Start as a bather

FREE · TODAY

- Apply to salons for bather work — it's the industry's ground floor.
- Learn safe handling, drying and prep on real dogs immediately.

### STEP 2 — Train as a groomer

WITHIN 6-12 MONTHS

- Formal grooming school or structured in-house training: clips, scissoring, skin and coat.
- Build a photo portfolio of your grooms from day one.

### STEP 3 — Work the table full-time

MONTHS 3-9

- Speed without stress is the skill; time your grooms and improve.
- Learn the booking system and rebooking habits of a healthy salon.

### STEP 4 — Plan the salon

MONTHS 6-12

- Lease math: tubs, tables, dryers, and groomer pay models.
- Write a service menu with time-based pricing for matted coats.

### STEP 5 — Open or buy in

MONTHS 9-12

- Bring clients from your following where agreements allow; recruit a bather first.
- Retail and add-ons from opening week — they're margin, not extras.

### STEP 6 — Fill and retain

YEAR 1

- Rebook every dog before it leaves; run a waitlist instead of overbooking.
- Groomer retention is owner job number one: pay, pace and respect.

## FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: list salons hiring bathers and grooming schools near you.
- Days 1–30: bathing shifts started; training path chosen.
- Days 31–60: first supervised grooms; portfolio growing.
- Days 61–90: grooming speed building; salon business plan drafted.
- Day 90: in the training pipeline — opening sits inside the 6–12 month band.

## NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **CALM HANDS. HAPPY DOGS.** ★